

Dr. Abdulla

Applied Economist | Policy Researcher | Development Specialist

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Website • GitHub

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Applied Econometrics

Agricultural & Climate Policy

Impact Evaluation

Trade & Development Economics

Labour Markets

RESEARCH PROFILE

Economist with 10+ years applying econometrics, causal inference, and statistical modeling to large-scale survey, administrative, and geospatial data to drive evidence-based decisions. Proven record of turning complex data into actionable insight, with 14 peer-reviewed publications. Skilled in reproducible analytical workflows, end-to-end study design, and communicating technical findings to non-technical and executive audiences.

RESEARCH & POLICY EXPERIENCE

Aug 2025–Present

Young Professional — Labour Markets & Public Policy

V.V. Giri National Labour Institute (VVGNI) — Ministry of Labour & Employment, GoI, Noida

- Developed research reports and policy briefs on labour market dynamics, employment, and livelihood sustainability, including econometric analyses on wages and informal employment using nationally representative micro-datasets.
- Led capacity-building workshops on applied econometrics and data-driven policy analysis for institutional researchers and civil servants.

Aug 2024–May 2025

Assistant Professor, Economics

Jamia Millia Islamia (Central University of National Importance) — New Delhi

- Mentored postgraduate empirical research in development economics, international trade, and applied econometrics. Maintained active research; published two WoS-indexed journal papers during tenure.
- Co-organised the *International Conference on Digital Banking & Sustainable Finance: Steps Towards Viksit Bharat@2047* (February 2025) during tenure.

Jul 2022–Aug 2024

Research Associate

ICAR–National Institute of Agricultural Economics & Policy Research (NIAP) — New Delhi

- Led econometric research for the National Innovations in Climate Resilient Agriculture (NICRA), applying advanced econometric models to assess climate risk and adaptation across 150+ vulnerable districts in India.
- Produced policy reports for national climate adaptation strategies, managed large-scale agricultural and socioeconomic datasets, and informed central government planning and resource allocation.

May 2022–Jul 2022

Young Professional — Economics & Trade Policy

Department of Commerce, Ministry of Commerce & Industry, Government of India — New Delhi

- Analyzed trade costs and efficiency using structural gravity models and global trade databases; developed policy briefs on India's export competitiveness and regional trade.
- Provided recommendations for free trade agreement negotiations and published research on India's trade.

Aug 2018–Aug 2024

Research Associate (multiple terms)

ICAR–NIAP / National Academy of Agricultural Sciences (NAAS) — New Delhi

- Led empirical research on agricultural productivity, market efficiency, value chains, and food security, authoring 12 peer-reviewed publications and contributing to national policy reports.
- Developed reproducible workflows in Stata, R, and Python for large-scale datasets, supporting government programme evaluation and impact assessment.

EDUCATION

2015–2018

Ph.D., Industrial Economics

Aligarh Muslim University — Aligarh, India

Thesis: "Performance of Sugar Mills in India: A Comparative Study of Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra"

2013–2015

M.Phil., Industrial Economics

Aligarh Muslim University — Aligarh, India

Thesis: "Efficiency of Sugar Mills in Uttar Pradesh: An Analysis"

2009–2011

M.A. in Economics (Econometrics & Mathematical Economics)

Aligarh Muslim University — Aligarh, India

2006–2009

B.A. (Hons.) in Economics (Mathematics & Statistics)

Aligarh Muslim University — Aligarh, India

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

— Forthcoming

- [1] Abdulla. Technical Efficiency of Contract Farming: Evidence from Potato Farmers in Gujarat. *Indian Journal of Agricultural Sciences* (Accepted, 2025). Ranks: Q3
- [2] Abdulla & Tariq Masood. Energy Efficiency and Technological Disparities in Indian Industrial Sectors. (Forthcoming).

— Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Agriculture, Food Systems & Climate

- [1] Bali, D. & Abdulla (2026). Farmer Producer Organisations and the Technical Efficiency of Vegetable Crops. *Economic & Political Weekly*, 61(2), 56–62. Ranks: Q3 ABDC-B
- [2] Kumar, N.R. & Abdulla (2024). Impact of Climate Change on Agriculture in the Indo-Gangetic Plains of India. *Agricultural Economics Research Review*, 37(1), 71–80. Ranks: ABDC-C
- [3] Kumar, S. & Abdulla (2022). Decomposing Productivity Growth in the Indian Sugar Industry. *Agricultural Economics Research Review*, 35(1), 71–80. Ranks: ABDC-C
- [4] Abdulla & Kumar, S. (2021). Technical Efficiency and its Determinants in the Indian Meat Processing Industry. *Indian Journal of Animal Sciences*, 91(3), 230–234. DOI. Ranks: Q4
- [5] Kumar, S. & Abdulla (2021). Dynamics of Productivity Growth in Indian Dairy Products Manufacturing Industry. *Indian Journal of Animal Sciences*, 91(2), 137–142. DOI. Ranks: Q4
- [6] Kumar, S. & Abdulla (2020). Dynamics of Technical Efficiency of Sugar Mills in India. *Indian Journal of Agricultural Sciences*, 90(8), 1532–1537. DOI. Ranks: Q3
- [7] Kumar, S., Abdulla & Singh, C.P. (2020). Productivity Growth in India's Bakery Manufacturing Industry. *Journal of Agribusiness in Developing and Emerging Economies*. DOI. Ranks: Q1 ABDC-C
- [8] Ahmad, M.I. & Abdulla (2017). Technical Efficiency and its Determinants: A Stochastic Frontier Analysis of Sugar Mills in Uttar Pradesh. *IUP Journal of Applied Economics*, 16(4). Ranks: ABDC-C

Trade, Labour, Industry & Social Development

- [9] Imran Ahmad & Abdulla (2026). India's Trade Cost, Trade Efficiency, and Trade Potential with South Asia: A Stochastic Frontier Gravity Approach. *Applied Economics*. Online First. Ranks: Q2 ABDC-A
- [10] Abdulla (2026). Labour Market Dynamics and Livelihood Sustainability in India. *Discover Sustainability*. Online First. Ranks: Q1
- [11] Khan, A.S. & Abdulla (2023). The Effect of Information Technology on Banking Efficiency. *Economic & Political Weekly*, 58(37), 40–46. Ranks: Q3 ABDC-B
- [12] Abdulla & Kumar, S. (2021). Technical Efficiency and its Determinants in the Indian Textile Garments Industry. *Research Journal of Textile and Apparel*, 25(4), 346–360. DOI. Ranks: Q2 ABDC-B
- [13] Khan, M.R. & Abdulla (2019). Dynamics of MSME Industry in Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra. *SEDME*, 46(4), 235–247. DOI. Ranks: ABDC-C
- [14] Abdulla & Ahmad, M.I. (2017). An Analysis of Poverty among Social and Religious Groups in Uttar Pradesh. *The Indian Economic Journal*, December (special issue). Ranks: Q3 ABDC-B

— Working Papers (Under Review)

- [1] Abdulla & Shiv Kumar. "Growth and Productivity Change in the Vegetable and Fruit Processing Industry in India."
- [2] Abdulla & P.S. Birthal. "A Non-Parametric Analysis of the Climate–Agriculture Nexus and Agricultural Productivity in India: Implications for Food Security."
- [3] Abdulla, MD Tajuddin Khan & D. Bali. "Irrigation Is Not Enough: Extreme Heat, Crop Vulnerability, and the Limits of Technological Adaptation in India."
- [4] Abdulla & N.R. Kumar. "Spatial Analysis of Climate-Induced Risk in Uttar Pradesh."
- [5] Abdulla & N.R. Kumar. "Assessing Agricultural Vulnerability in Uttar Pradesh: Evidence from Block-Level Data."
- [6] Abdulla & Kalu Naik. "Stunting Falls, Anaemia Rises: India's Nutritional Transition and the Aspirational Districts Programme."

— Books & Book Chapters

- [1] Abdulla (2025). *Spreadsheet Modelling (MBA-1008)*. Centre for Distance Education, Aligarh Muslim University, Aligarh.

[2] Abdulla, Kumar, S., & Singh, D. (2019). Total Factor Productivity using Stochastic Frontier Production Function. In *Quantitative Methods for Social Sciences* (pp. 264–274). ICAR–NIAP, New Delhi.

RESEARCH GRANTS

2025–2026	Co-Principal Investigator, ICSSR Minor Research Project <i>Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR)</i> — New Delhi “Assessing the Impact of Jal Jeevan Mission on Rural Health Outcomes using Mixed-Method Evaluation.” Employs a mixed-method design combining difference-in-differences estimation with qualitative field data to evaluate a flagship national rural water programme.
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QUANTITATIVE METHODS, DATA & SOFTWARE

Methods	Structural Gravity Modelling · Panel Data Analysis · Stochastic Frontier Analysis (SFA) · Data Envelopment Analysis (DEA) · Spatial Econometrics · Impact Evaluation (DiD, IV, RDD) · Non-Parametric Analysis · Macroeconomic Modelling
International Data	World Development Indicators (WDI) · WITS · ITC Trade Map · UN Comtrade · FAOSTAT · ILO KILM · UNDP Human Development Data · IMF Balance of Payments · World Bank PIP / PovcalNet
National Data	NSSO · ASI · NFHS · CMIE Prowess · National Accounts Statistics (NAS) · RBI Monetary & Banking Data · District-level administrative datasets
Software	Stata (advanced) · R · Python · SPSS · EViews · Tableau · Power BI · ArcGIS · QGIS · LaTeX
Languages	English (Proficient) · Hindi (Native) · Urdu (Native)

PROFESSIONAL ENGAGEMENT

Peer Review	Reviewer for major publishers including Emerald, Springer Nature, Frontiers, Inderscience, SAGE, and Elsevier across management, economics, and social sciences.
Memberships	International Association of Agricultural Economists (IAAE) · Indian Economic Association (IEA)
International Conferences	32nd International Conference of Agricultural Economists (ICAE 2024), New Delhi — presenter. Indian Economic Association Annual Conferences (2016, 2017) — presenter.
Capacity Building	Delivered six invited lectures and workshops on econometric methods, microdata analysis, and structural gravity modelling at AMU, Jamia Millia Islamia, University of Calicut, ICAR–NAARM, and VVGNLI (2021–2026).

REFEREES

Dr Arvind Director General V.V. Giri National Labour Institute (VVGNLI) Ministry of Labour & Employment, GoI dg.vvgnli@gov.in	Dr Shiv Kumar Director & Head, Division of Agricultural Markets & Trade ICAR–NIAP, New Delhi shivkumardhull@gmail.com
Dr P. S. Birthal Former Director, ICAR–NIAP New Delhi psbirthal@gmail.com	Dr P. K. Joshi Former Director, South Asia Office International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI) pkj.in@outlook.com

I hereby declare that all statements made herein are true to the best of my knowledge and belief.
Place: New Delhi Date: June 3, 2026 **ABDULLA**